Course 5: Agile Project Management

Module 1-The fundamentals of Agile

Waterfall: The sequential or linear ordering of phases

Agile: Being able to move quickly and easily. Flexibility and the willingness and ability to change and adapt

Agile's iterative approach enables a project to move quickly, as well as making it adaptive to change.

Agile project management: An approach to project and team management that embodies "agility" and is based on the Agile Manifesto

The Manifesto is a collection of four values and 12 principles that define the mindset that all Agile teams should strive for.

- Agile values, principles, and frameworks have been applied to every industry
- Agile methods draw heavily on Lean manufacturing principles
- Agile aims to get customer feedback more quickly
- Working with an Agile mindset means always finding ways to work more efficiently by focusing on streamlining the process without reducing product quality or value
- Agile aims to reduce waste

Aspects of a project

- Requirements
- Documentation
- Deliverables

Requirements: Conditions that must be met or tasks that must be finished to ensure the successful completion of the project

Deliverable: A tangible outcome from a project

The 4 Agile values

1. Individuals and interactions over processes and tools
2. Working software over comprehensive documentation
3. Customer collaboration over contract negotiation
4. Responding to change over following a plan

Agile values and principles inform the why, how, and what of Agile project management planning and processes. They value individual perspectives and creativity as important contributions to the success of the project. Work together, collaborate, and help each other achieve the best outcomes possible.

Value Delivery

- Our highest priority is to satisfy the customer through early and continuous delivery of valuable software.
- Deliver working software frequently, from a couple of weeks to a couple of months, with a preference for the shorter timescale.

- Working software is the primary measure of progress.
- Simplicity—the art of maximizing the amount of work not done—is essential.
- Continuous attention to technical excellence and good design enhances agility.
- Delivering the work as quickly as possible in order to get feedback and mitigate time risk.
- Simplicity allows a team to work on the things that matter most.

Business Collaboration

- Welcome changing requirements, even late in development. Agile processes harness change for the customer's competitive advantage.
- Business people and developers must work together daily throughout the project.
- Collaborating with your customers helps the team get critical business information immediately, allowing them to adjust and adapt to any new information instantly.

Team Dynamics and Culture

- Build projects around motivated individuals. Give them the environment and support they need, and trust them to get the job done.
- The most efficient and effective method of conveying information to and within a development team is face-to-face conversation.
- Agile processes promote sustainable development. The sponsors, developers, and users should be able to maintain a constant pace indefinitely.
- The best architectures, requirements, and designs emerge from self-organizing teams.
- Create an effective team culture that is inclusive, supportive, and empowering.

Make sure your team:

- Is motivated to do the right thing
- Feels trusted to do the right thing
- Has the resources and space to work closely together on their goals
- Works at a sustainable pace

Retrospectives and Continuous Learning

At regular intervals, the team reflects on how to become more effective, then tunes and adjusts its behavior accordingly. Strive to continuously learn and adapt to what's working and what's not.

Questions for improvement:

- How is the team doing?
- Are the customers happy?
- Are there processes we could optimize? Are our tools working for us?
- Are we following the values?
- Are we accumulating any debt, technical or otherwise?

History of Agile

- Agile was introduced in 2001 by 17 individuals who combined lightweight processes to improve software development.
- It quickly expanded beyond software to various industries due to its effectiveness.

The 12 Agile Principles Summary

1. Prioritize customer satisfaction through early and continuous delivery of valuable software.
2. Welcome changing requirements, even late in development, to maintain competitive advantage.
3. Deliver working software frequently, preferring shorter timescales.
4. Business people and developers must collaborate daily.
5. Build projects around motivated individuals and trust them.
6. Face-to-face conversation is the most effective communication method.
7. Working software is the primary measure of progress.
8. Promote sustainable development with a constant pace.
9. Continuous attention to technical excellence enhances agility.
10. Simplicity is essential by maximizing work not done.
11. Best architectures and designs emerge from self-organizing teams.
12. Teams regularly reflect and adjust to become more effective.

Agile is about delivering value in a world with high degrees of uncertainty, risk, and competition. It works best in industries or projects that are susceptible to or that encourage change and uncertainty.

VUCA

An acronym that defines the conditions that affect organizations in a changing and complex world:

- **Volatility:** Refers to the rate of change and churn in a business or situation.
- **Uncertainty:** Refers to the lack of predictability or high potential for surprise.
- **Complexity:** Refers to the high number of interrelated forces, issues, organizations, and factors that would influence the project.
- **Ambiguity:** Refers to the possibility of misunderstanding the conditions and root causes of events or circumstances.

Developed as a way to deal with these forces in a changing and uncertain world. Businesses can apply the concept of VUCA as a tool for determining how best to approach projects. When starting on a new project, it's helpful to examine the environment and conditions in which the project exists before deciding the best approach to use. If your project has high levels of VUCA parameters, it's a good sign you should consider an Agile approach. An Agile approach will lead to better outcomes by giving you and your team tools and systems to mitigate VUCA risks.

Introduction to Frameworks

Product Backlog: The central artifact in Scrum, where all possible ideas, deliverables, features, or tasks are captured for the team to work on.

Sprint: A time-boxed iteration in Scrum where work is done.

Daily Scrum: A meeting of 15 or fewer minutes every day of the Sprint.

Reasons for Scrum's popularity: Clear roles and responsibilities, while continuously emphasizing the power of the team as a whole formats, and outcomes; supports and reinforces the Agile values and principles, while adding structure and foundations that help new Agile teams get started and more experienced teams get better; free and open for all to use with huge amounts of online guidance, support, training, and certifications; regular and predictable meeting and delivery schedules.

Scrum was first described in 1986 in the Harvard Business Review, inspired by the rugby term where players huddle closely to gain possession of the ball and work together to score. The original paper by Takeuchi and Nonaka emphasized team characteristics that help "move the Scrum downfield," such as built-in instability and self-organizing teams.

Key Characteristics of Scrum Teams: Built-in instability provides teams with challenging requirements that create tension necessary for strategic projects. Self-organizing teams operate autonomously without strict hierarchy, fostering continuous growth and collaboration. Overlapping development phases require team members to synchronize their pace, forming a collective rhythm. Scrum relies on multi-learning through trial and error and staying responsive to changing market conditions. Subtle control is maintained via checkpoints to monitor progress without stifling creativity. Organizational transfer of learning encourages team members to acquire new skills and support each other.

Kanban

From Japanese: Kan = "sign", Ban = "board".

Benefits of Kanban: Provides transparent visual feedback; ensures that the project team only accepts a sustainable amount of in-progress work.

Work-in-Progress (WIP) Limit: Tasks are limited to what the team can actually handle during a certain amount of time.

Flow: A core principle of Kanban that aims to maximize efficiency.

Extreme Programming (XP)

- Aims to improve product quality and the ability to respond to changing customer needs.
- Takes best practices for the development process to "extreme" levels.
- XP wants to ensure that all of the pieces of the product will fit together properly, so it stresses simplicity.
- XP demands clear and concise code so that others can easily read and understand the program.
- The goal is to test for and eliminate any flaws in a feature before building it and continuing on.

XP Activities: Designing, Coding, Testing, Listening. (Listening to the customer and ensuring that the requirements are integrated into the product).

XP Innovative Practices: Pair Programming (two team members work together at the same time on one task); Continuous Integration and Continuous Refactoring (merging product changes into a shared version of the product); Avoid Big Design Up Front (design is just enough to get started and should be continuously improved as the product evolves).

5 Principles of Lean

1. **Define value:** Identify and focus on what the customer wants and include the customer.
2. **Map value stream:** Map out the steps to production and challenge all wasted steps.
3. **Create flow:** Ensure the product flows through the value stream efficiently, eliminating waste throughout the cycle.
4. **Establish pull:** Ensure the customer is "pulling" on the product through this stream by asking for features and incremental deliveries.
5. **Pursue perfection:** Push the team to continuously improve the first four process steps.

Agile is a way of thinking about the project delivery process through the values and principles of the Manifesto. Agile values and principles can be achieved through certain project delivery frameworks and methods. The real power of Agile comes from not only adopting certain processes, but also from adopting a certain mindset that is different from traditional Waterfall models.

Waterfall project management phases

- Initiation
- Planning
- Executing and completing tasks
- Closing out the project

Reasons to blend Waterfall and Agile styles

- Your stakeholders, customers, or sponsors are more comfortable with traditional approaches and workflows, but your project team is already established in Scrum.
- Regulatory requirements insist on certain traditional work processes.
- A vendor is already following a traditional approach and the integration between the teams requires some blending of methods.

Key points: Agile is a mindset. Agile values and principles can be achieved through certain frameworks and delivery methods. Agile and Waterfall are both effective ways of approaching project management.

The Spotify Model Structure

- Spotify organizes teams into Squads, Tribes, Chapters, and Guilds to balance autonomy, collaboration, and communication.
- Squads function like Scrum teams, self-organizing around specific missions with a Product Owner and Agile coach support.
- Tribes group multiple Squads working in related areas, keeping team sizes manageable (under 100 people).
- Chapters connect people with similar skills across Tribes, while Guilds are broader communities sharing knowledge and practices.
- The Spotify model encourages continuous adaptation rather than strict copying; what works for Spotify may not fit every team. Teams should experiment, adjust, and evolve their Agile practices to find the right balance of collaboration and ownership for their unique needs.

Module 2-Scrum 101

Agile is the foundational philosophy and mindset, while Scrum is a framework that materializes and brings that philosophy to life.

Scrum theory: 3 pillars, 5 values.

Scrum Team roles: Product Owner, Scrum Master, Development Team.

Scrum: A framework for developing, delivering, and sustaining complex products.

Iterative: Repeating cycles of delivery.

Incremental: Work is divided into smaller chunks that build on each other.

Empiricism: The idea that true knowledge comes from actual, lived experience.

The Three Pillars of Scrum

- **Transparency:** Make the most significant aspects of our work visible to those responsible for the outcome. Transparency inside a Scrum team is critical to the team's productivity and the project's completion.
- **Inspection:** Conducting timely checks towards the outcome of a Sprint goal to detect undesirable variances. The more inspections that take place, the more improvement a team experiences in their work.
- **Adaptation:** Adjusting project, product, or processes to minimize any further deviation or issues. Although adaptation includes immediate fixes to problems, it may also be about implementing a change, so future projects don't repeat past mistakes.

Five values of Scrum

1. **Commitment:** Personally committing to achieving the goals of the Scrum Team.
2. **Courage:** The Scrum Team members must have the courage to do the right thing and work on tough problems.
3. **Focus:** Everyone focusing on the work of the Sprint and the overall goals of the Scrum Team.
4. **Openness:** The Scrum Team and its stakeholders agree to be open about all of the work and challenges with performing the work.
5. **Respect:** Team members should respect the opinions, skills, and independence of their teammates.

In order for a team to bring the three pillars of Scrum to life, they must act in accordance with the five Scrum values.

Vision Parameters

Mission: A short statement that stays constant for your team throughout the process and gives them something to work toward.

Product vision: When you set a vision, you're making it clear what the team is responsible for and where your team's boundaries are. A mission tells me why we're doing the work. A product vision helps me imagine what the work will be like when we're done.

Scrum Roles Deep Dive

Scrum Teams are cross-functional and self-organizing (or self-managing). When a Scrum Team delivers something, it's the accomplishment of the entire team.

The Scrum Master: Promotes and supports the Scrum process by helping everyone understand and implement Scrum. Responsible for ensuring the team understands and follows Scrum theory and practices. Acts as a coach, facilitates Scrum events, removes impediments/blockers, prevents unhelpful interactions from outside of the team, and helps the team improve within the Scrum framework. Key skills include organization, leadership, facilitation, coaching, great communication, and stakeholder management.

The Product Owner: Tasked with ensuring that the team is building the right product or service. Continuously maximizes the value of the product delivered by the Scrum Team. Helps the Scrum Team understand why their work matters within the overall goal and mission. Prioritizes the Product Backlog to optimize delivery and value to customers. Ensures the Backlog is visible and transparent to all, and makes sure the product or service fulfills the customers' needs. Key traits: Customer-focused, decisive, flexible, optimistic, positive, available, and collaborative.

The Development Team (or Developers): The people who do the work to build the product. Composed of cross-functional members who build the product incrementally each Sprint. Plans the Sprint, adheres to quality standards, adapts daily to meet goals, and holds each other accountable. Key traits: Cross-functional, self-organizing, supportive, customer-oriented, focused, collaborative, and professional.

Module 3-Implementing Scrum

Product Backlog: A key Scrum artifact that lists all project tasks, features, and requirements in one place and must be regularly updated to reflect evolving needs. It is a living artifact owned and adjusted by the Product Owner as a prioritized list of features.

User stories: Short, simple descriptions of a feature told from the perspective of the user. Formatted as: *As a <user role> I want this <action> so that I can get this <value>.* User stories help teams focus on user goals and experience.

I.N.V.E.S.T. Criteria: Independent, Negotiable, Valuable, Estimable, Small, Testable.

Acceptance criteria: The checklist you will use to decide whether the user story is done.

Epics: Large user stories that group related smaller user stories to organize work that cannot be completed in a single iteration. They help manage and structure the project by categorizing user stories into broader themes or features (e.g., "website creation").

Both Product Owners and Developers can write user stories and epics, but the Product Owner remains accountable for the Product Backlog items.

Work management tools like Asana help reduce time lost to searching for information, switching apps, and meetings by streamlining project planning and team alignment. Asana offers templates such as the Sprint Planning template to help create and organize Product Backlogs. User stories are added as tasks in the Backlog column, with acceptance criteria added as subtasks, and custom fields can be used to tag tasks with epics.

Backlog Refinement & Estimation

Backlog refinement: The act of keeping the Backlog described, estimated, and prioritized so that the Scrum Team can operate effectively. Review the Product Backlog to ensure it contains the appropriate items, items are prioritized by the Product Owner (setting the order field), items at the top are ready for delivery with clear acceptance criteria, and items include estimates.

Through estimation we can find out how much work we have ahead of us. Avoids false precision by focusing on relative estimates rather than exact time. Prevents anchoring bias by keeping initial estimates private, promotes inclusivity, team trust, and helps discover effort strategies.

- **Relative estimation:** Instead of trying to determine exactly how long a task will take, we compare the effort of that task to another task, and that becomes the estimate.
- **Fibonacci sequence:** 0, 1, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13, 21... Helpful because, as the estimate gets higher, the uncertainty and risk also gets higher.
- **Planning Poker™:** A consensus-based method using Fibonacci sequence cards to estimate effort for a small number of items, avoiding bias by revealing estimates simultaneously.
- **Dot Voting:** Team members use color-coded dot stickers to vote on the effort required for each item, suitable for a low number of sprint backlog items.
- **The Bucket System:** Quickly estimates many items by placing them into metaphorical "buckets" of effort levels, allowing fast sorting and consensus.
- **Large/Uncertain/Small:** A rough estimation method categorizing items into three groups based on complexity, useful for similar or comparable backlog items.

- **Ordering Method:** Items are placed on a scale from low to high effort, and team members adjust positions until consensus is reached, ideal for smaller teams with many items.
- **Affinity Mapping:** Uses sticky notes to group items by similarity and prioritize groups, effective for backlogs with more than 20 items.

Using Asana for Effort: Asana automatically creates custom fields like "Estimate (Story Points)" where you can input effort estimates. You can sort user stories by custom fields like "Value", save layouts, and switch to Board view for a Kanban-style backlog. Projects can be created by uploading a CSV file.

Sprints & Events

Within a Sprint, the amount of work is planned based on the historical capacity of the team and is made ready for the Sprint Planning event. The Scrum Guide defines: The Sprint, Sprint Planning, Daily Scrum, Sprint Review, and Sprint Retrospective.

Timeboxes: Create a sense of urgency which will drive prioritization; provide a window of focus which will translate into productivity gains; help the team develop a predictable rhythm to their work. When determining length, think about: frequency of changes, focused time developers need, and overhead that goes into a "delivery".

Sprint Overview: Sprints are time-boxed events of one month or less where ideas are transformed into value. A new Sprint begins immediately after the previous one ends. During a Sprint, no changes should jeopardize the Sprint Goal, quality must be maintained, and scope can be clarified or renegotiated with the Product Owner. Shorter Sprints reduce risk and increase learning cycles. A Sprint can be canceled by the Product Owner if the Sprint Goal becomes obsolete.

Sprint Planning: The entire Scrum Team comes together and meets to confirm how much capacity (time and people) is available. This becomes the Sprint Backlog and ultimately the Sprint Goal.

Definition of Done: Refers to an agreed-upon set of items that must be completed before a user story or Backlog item can be considered complete. Shared agreement on quality measures. Includes: code/solution reviewed by an independent peer group; product or unit passes all testing requirements (security/performance); documentation is completed; Product Owner accepts the user story; and all user story acceptance criteria specified by the Product Owner are met.

Daily Scrum / Standups: Time for the Scrum Team to synchronize and prioritize activities for the day. Typically 15 to 20 minutes, focusing on what was completed, current work, and obstacles. Fosters camaraderie and visibility. Schedule considering time zones and team consensus.

Sprint Review: A meeting with the entire Scrum Team where the product is demonstrated in order to determine which aspects are finished (done) and which aren't. Makes feedback immediate and gives everyone a voice.

Product Increment: What is produced after a given Sprint. It is potentially releasable, meaning complete, tested, and usable.

Minimum Viable Product (MVP): Version of a product with just enough features to satisfy early customers and gather validated learning. An MVP may consist of multiple increments, while a releasable increment is produced every Sprint.

Sprint Retrospective

An essential meeting of up to 3 hours for the Scrum Team to take a step back, reflect, and identify improvements about how to work together as a team regarding people, processes, and tools. Pitfalls to avoid: overusing gimmicks/games, focusing solely on negatives, or changing processes after every single retrospective (allow time to evaluate over several Sprints). Best practices: blamelessness, open-ended questions, diverse communication styles (silent reflection), and actionable balance.

Metrics & Tracking

Burndown chart: Measures time against the amount of work done and amount of work remaining.

Velocity: The measure of how many story points the team completes/burns down in a given Sprint, representing the team's capacity. Refined over subsequent sprints. Helps teams decide what to include in the Sprint Backlog. Cautions: sharing with outsiders requires context; should not be used as a performance metric or for comparing different teams; using it to predict delivery dates can create false expectations.

Core principles for tools: Visualization, Work-in-progress limits, and Flow of work. Types of tools: Documentation/word processing, spreadsheets, presentations, video conferencing, chats, emails.

Module 4-Applying Agile in the organization

Value can mean different things for each customer based on what they expect the product to accomplish. "Value-driven delivery" means you and your team are focused on delivering a product of high value.

- **Build the right thing:** Understand what your customers want
- **Build the thing right:** Ensure that the team only builds the requested or approved features
- **Run it right:** Your team has thought through how the user will interact with the product once it's been delivered (How do users get support? How does the product add value long after? How do new features reach existing users?)

Case studies provide detailed, data-driven insights into how organizations implement Agile. When analyzing case studies, consider the problem, its impact, context, alternatives, and recommendations. *Example: Value-Driven Delivery at Penta formed an Agile task force to implement scrum-team-based problem solving involving cross-functional collaboration. "It's not always about it being perfect. It's about being good."*

Value Roadmap

An Agile way of mapping out the product development process, used to identify important milestones and explain the vision. It components include: Product Vision, Product Roadmap, and Release Plans.

- **Product vision:** What the product is, how it supports business strategy, and who will use it.
- **Product roadmap:** High-level view of the expected product, its requirements, and an estimated schedule for milestones. Product release dates should only be rough estimates.
- **Release plan:** Release goal, list of Backlog items, estimated release date, and other relevant dates. Connects the roadmap with the team's capacity and velocity. Factored into "hard" dates. Product Owner and Project Manager/Scrum Master must work together to review it before Sprint Planning. Release plans change due to team velocity changes, changes to product scope, or improved understanding of effort.

Pitfalls to avoid with roadmaps: treating them as fixed and unchangeable, over-focusing on exact delivery dates too early, and spending too much time on the roadmap instead of deliverables.

Managing Change & Triple Constraint

Changes may involve scope (what is delivered), time (when it is delivered), or costs/resources (how it is delivered), known as the triple constraint. Changes can be identified by any stakeholder through feedback, retrospectives, or shifts in dependencies. A single person, usually the Product Owner or senior stakeholder, should be the decider to ensure accountability. To implement: document the change, update all relevant project artifacts (roadmaps, backlogs), communicate to stakeholders, and monitor impact over time.

Organizational Culture & Change Management

Organizational culture: Based on shared workplace values; demonstrated through people's behaviors, activities, the way they communicate, and how they work with each other.

Change management: The process of getting people to adopt a new product, process, or a new value system.

- **Creating a sense of ownership:** Find an executive sponsor who also feels a sense of ownership for the change. Having buy-in from someone at the top increases successfully driving any change.
- **Creating a sense of urgency:** Ask questions about what's working and what's not right now (What is preventing us from providing the best product? What allows competitors to outperform us? How can we help our teams become more productive?).

Influence Frameworks

Three keys to influence: Clarify measurable results (Set specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound S.M.A.R.T goals that are visible); Find vital behaviors (Identify pivotal actions based on current patterns and expert insights); and utilize the six sources of influence.

The six sources of influence: Personal and social motivation and ability (engage internal motivation, skills, social encouragement); Structural motivation and ability (use rewards, incentives, and environmental factors to make the desired behavior easier than the old behavior).

Leadership Styles: Managing vs. Coaching

Managing: Involves directing and overseeing work, including onboarding, delegating tasks, monitoring progress, and making decisions. Agile teams are self-managing, but managers step in decisively during emergencies, tight deadlines, or specific client needs.

Coaching: Focuses on two-way communication to develop team members' skills, motivation, and judgment by teaching critical thinking and decision-making. Coaches motivate, support, and encourage teams, building confidence for continuous improvement. Preferred initial approach in Agile.

4 Themes of Agile Principles Troubleshooting

1. **Value delivery:** About making sure the team is delivering working solutions frequently.
    - *Issues:* Missing expected delivery dates, burnout, too many items "in progress".
    - *Solutions:* More demos of the solutions, use Retrospectives, clarify what "done" means, focus on only a few user stories per Sprint.
2. **Business collaboration:** Developers collaborating with business people on building the right product.
    - *Solutions:* Addressing critical feedback/change requests via more demos, conducting a solution design Sprint, introducing Backlog changes only in between Sprints.
3. **Team dynamics and culture:** Fostering human collaboration.
    - *Issues:* Low team morale, lots of conflict, or low conflict.
    - *Solutions:* Run a team brainstorm session, change up the workflows, take a training class together.
4. **Retrospectives:** Continuous reflection and learning workflows.

Common Coaching Challenges

- **Challenge #1: Managing an unstable product roadmap:**
    - *Product ambition:* Leadership is overly ambitious. *Solutions:* Agree upfront how to handle new opportunities, set up regular roadmap reviews, promote knowledge sharing between PO and Developers.

    - *Product assumptions:* Too many assumptions jeopardize success. *Solutions:* Document assumptions to make them transparent, check them against unbiased user research (gathers info on what users really want, rejects assumptions, moves forward with confidence).

- **Challenge #2: Incomplete implementation of Scrum:** Loss of clear roles, temptation to skip or blend events to save time, not providing Scrum coaching. *Solutions:* Implement Scrum completely, ensure roles are well defined and properly fulfilled.
- **Challenge #3: Lack of team stability:** Changes in team composition. *Solutions:* Have a quick onboarding process, use pair programming, have shorter Sprints.

DevOps & Scaling Frameworks

DevOps: An organizational and cultural movement that aims to increase software delivery velocity, improve service reliability, and build shared ownership among software stakeholders. Evolving large-scale systems securely and rapidly.

Business agility: Incorporating Agile principles into the wide sphere of management.

- **Scaled Agile Framework (SAFe):** Integrates Lean, Scrum, Kanban, XP, DevOps, and Design Thinking to deliver value through Agile Release Trains aligned with value streams. Emphasizes alignment, built-in quality, transparency, program execution, and leadership.
- **Scrum of Scrums:** Coordinates multiple Scrum teams working on the same project through regular Scrum of Scrums meetings, relying on Scrum Masters or ambassadors to facilitate communication.
- **Large-Scale Scrum (LeSS):** Extends Scrum principles to larger groups, focusing on customer-centricity, transparency, continuous improvement, and lean thinking. Offers Basic LeSS (up to 50 people) and LeSS Huge.
- **Disciplined Agile Delivery (DAD):** A hybrid framework combining elements from various Agile methods to guide process decisions based on context. Layers include Foundations, Disciplined DevOps, Value Streams, and Disciplined Agile Enterprise.
- **Spotify Model:** Cultural approach emphasizing autonomous Squads, Tribes, Chapters, and Guilds to foster agility, team autonomy, accountability, and quality.

Best Practices for Scaling Agile: Treat scaling frameworks as adaptable guides, not strict rules; ensure teams have Agile experience before scaling; and avoid scaling unnecessarily, as larger teams increase complexity and potential waste.

Agile Careers & Interviews

Positions: Agile Project Manager, Scrum Master, IT Agile Project Manager, DevOps Project Manager. Look for a role that suits your experience level, complements domain expertise, offers growth, and matches culture fit.

Interview Questions & Answers:

- *What is the difference between Agile and Waterfall project management?* Responses should demonstrate that Agile is about more than just Scrum, Sprints, and Standups; it is about founding values (customer collaboration, value delivery, self-organizing teams); and show an understanding that all projects benefit from certain types of approaches, including Waterfall. Show how Agile helps a PM with specific challenges.
- *If you are facing resistance with your team following a Scrum or Agile practice, how do you convince them to give it a try?* Responses should demonstrate the candidate is aware of how to use communication and influencing skills; provides evidence that the candidate truly believes an Agile

team can be self-organizing; and shows they will work with a team and not try to force certain processes.

Questions for a candidate to ask employers: How supportive is management towards blending project management approaches? What is the first thing I should know about the culture here? How often will I get to hear about the needs of our users or customers? What would a typical day look like for me if I were to take on this position?

How to introduce Agile to a team: Start small, listen to feedback, be strategic, and find allies.